Path-aware Retrieval Matches the Query

Same retriever, different query forms → use a path-specific title policy

DIRECT PATH

Long original question

More words · multiple constraints

TITLE MATCHING **OFF**

Passage content only

Keep the full question

✕ **Avoid noisy title hits**

A stray keyword can retrieve an irrelevant article.

DECOMPOSITION PATH

Short sub-question

Entity-focused · one knowledge need

Who directed Inception?

TITLE MATCHING **ON**

Title + passage

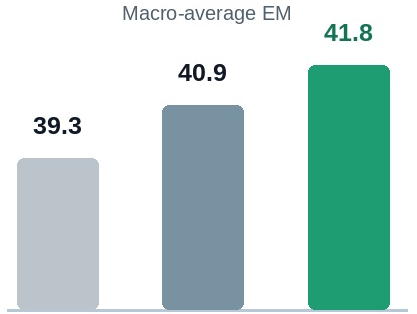
Use the entity as an anchor

OK **Find the right article**

The title points directly to the target entity.

TITLE POLICY COMPARISON

UNIFORM OFF	UNIFORM ON	PATH-AWARE
Direct OFF	Direct ON	Direct OFF
Decomp OFF	Decomp ON	Decomp ON



Path-aware: best EM on 4 / 4 datasets

Adaptive retrieval is not only whether to retrieve — it is also how to retrieve for each path.